

# LEAVE POLICY

## Employee Leave & Time-Off Guidelines

|                |                                                     |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Policy Owner   | Human Resources                                     |
| Applies To     | All regular employees, unless otherwise specified   |
| Effective Date | 01 September 2026                                   |
| Review Cycle   | Annually or when business/legal requirements change |
| Version        | 1.0                                                 |

### 1. Purpose

This policy establishes a clear and consistent framework for requesting, approving, recording, and managing employee leave. It is intended to support employee wellbeing while ensuring adequate staffing and continuity of business operations.

### 2. Scope

This policy applies to all regular full-time and part-time employees of the organization. Contractual, temporary, trainee, intern, or consultant arrangements may be governed by separate terms where applicable.

### 3. Leave Categories

Employees may be eligible for the following categories of leave, subject to applicable employment terms and statutory requirements:

| Leave Type                       | Purpose / General Use                                                 | Typical Entitlement*                   |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Casual Leave (CL)                | Short-duration personal matters, urgent needs, or occasional absence. | 12 days / year                         |
| Sick Leave (SL)                  | Illness, medical recovery, or medically necessary absence.            | 12 days / year                         |
| Earned / Privilege Leave (EL/PL) | Planned vacation, extended personal time, or rest.                    | 18 days / year                         |
| Public / Company Holidays        | Declared national, regional, and company holidays.                    | As per annual holiday calendar         |
| Maternity Leave                  | Pregnancy, childbirth, and related statutory leave.                   | As per applicable law                  |
| Paternity / Parental Leave       | Support for childbirth, adoption, or parental responsibilities.       | As per company policy / applicable law |
| Bereavement Leave                | Death of an immediate family member.                                  | Up to 5 working days                   |
| Unpaid Leave (LWP)               | Approved absence when paid leave is unavailable or not applicable.    | Subject to approval                    |

\* Entitlements shown are illustrative organizational defaults and should be aligned with the organization's employment terms and applicable law.

### 4. Leave Request Procedure

- **Planned leave:** Submit a leave request through the designated HR/leave-management system before the intended absence.
- **Advance notice:** Wherever reasonably possible, employees should provide at least 3 working days' notice for planned leave and longer notice for extended leave.

- **Urgent leave:** In emergencies or unexpected situations, notify the reporting manager as soon as reasonably practicable.
- **Approval:** Leave is considered approved only after authorization by the designated approving manager, except where statutory provisions provide otherwise.
- **Handover:** Employees taking planned leave should communicate critical deadlines, pending work, and handover details to the relevant team members.

## 5. Leave Approval Principles

- Approval depends on business requirements, staffing levels, project deadlines, and the employee's available leave balance.
- Managers should apply the policy consistently and avoid unreasonable or discriminatory treatment.
- Leave should not be denied or restricted where an employee is exercising a statutory entitlement and has satisfied applicable requirements.
- Employees should not assume approval merely because a request has been submitted.

## 6. Sick Leave and Medical Documentation

- Employees should inform their manager promptly when illness prevents them from attending work.
- A medical certificate or other supporting documentation may be requested for extended sick leave, repeated absence, or where required by applicable law/company rules.
- Medical information should be handled confidentially and only accessed by authorized personnel.

## 7. Maternity, Paternity and Parental Leave

Maternity, paternity, adoption, and other parental leave will be administered in accordance with applicable Indian law and the organization's current benefits and employment policies. Where statutory requirements provide greater protection or entitlement than this policy, the statutory requirement will prevail.

## 8. Leave During Probation / Notice Period

- Leave eligibility during probation may be subject to the employee's appointment terms and applicable law.
- During a notice period, leave requests may require additional planning to ensure proper transition and handover.
- Statutory leave rights remain subject to applicable law and cannot be overridden by this general provision.

## 9. Leave Carry-Forward and Encashment

Carry-forward, lapse, and encashment of unused leave will be governed by the specific leave category, employment terms, and applicable law. Employees should review their available balance and applicable year-end rules before the close of each leave year.

## 10. Unauthorised Absence

Absence without required notification or approval may be treated as unauthorized absence and may result in leave adjustment or disciplinary action in accordance with the organization's disciplinary procedures and applicable law.

## 11. Holidays Falling During Leave

Treatment of public/company holidays occurring during a period of approved leave will depend on the applicable leave category and organizational rules. The HR team should be consulted where the treatment is unclear.

## 12. Leave Records and Responsibilities

- **Employees:** Submit accurate requests, provide required documentation, maintain communication, and complete necessary handovers.
- **Managers:** Review requests promptly, apply the policy fairly, and maintain adequate team coverage.
- **HR:** Maintain leave records, clarify policy interpretation, monitor compliance, and update the policy when required.

## 13. Policy Exceptions

Any exception to this policy must be approved by the appropriate authority and documented where required. Exceptions cannot be used to reduce an employee's mandatory statutory rights.

## 14. Compliance and Governing Requirements

This policy is intended as a general organizational framework. Where any provision conflicts with applicable employment legislation, government notifications, or binding employment terms, the applicable legal or contractual requirement will prevail.

## 15. Contact

For questions regarding leave balances, eligibility, documentation, or special circumstances, employees should contact the Human Resources team or their designated HR representative.

|                        |                                      |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>Document Status</b> | Approved / Controlled Policy         |
| <b>Prepared By</b>     | Human Resources                      |
| <b>Approved By</b>     | Authorized Management Representative |
| <b>Next Review</b>     | Within 12 months of effective date   |